

superstition; and it is therefore significant that he had no fear of the wrath of the sacred element when he burnt the corpse of Amasis.¹ This fact may be put with similar notes from the life of Xerxes, and with the well-known argument from the burial of the Achæmenian kings, to show that the Magi had not yet come upon the scene: for all this see p. 215 f. The other fact about Cambyses' religion is the Egyptian text, quoted by Dr Gray, which shows him worshipping the goddess Neit at Sais, as Darius did after him. He acted presumably from a very real fear of the possible consequences of offending the local gods in foreign countries, where *omne ignotum pro magnifico* probably counted more heavily than the politic motives which preponderated with statesmen like Cyrus and Darius.

Before we pass on to consider the religion of Darius, a man for whom religion was obviously a very real experience, we may look into some questions concerning the Achæmenians in general. I quoted just now what seems to be Prof. E. Meyer's one reason for regarding Cyrus as a Zoroastrian—his unwillingness to make Darius an innovator. It is important, therefore, to notice considerations leading us to postulate a rather marked difference between the two branches of the *Haxāmanišiya* clan. Cyrus was king in Elam, while Darius expressly claims that his ancestors were "royal" from Achæmenes down, and possessed "this kingdom which Gaumāta the Magian took from Cambyses . . . both Persia and Media and the other provinces" (*Bh* i. 12). Media at any rate was not ruled by Achæmenians before Cyrus; but Persia

¹ Herodotus, iii. 16.